

Software Project Requirements Checklist

Everything worth deciding before you request a quote, organized into seven short sections, so the proposal you get back is accurate, the timeline is realistic, and nothing gets missed.

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BEFORE YOU REQUEST A QUOTE

How to use this checklist

Most fixed-price quotes that change mid-project don't change because of bad estimating. They change because requirements were still being discovered after the contract was already signed. This checklist exists to surface that thinking earlier, while it's still cheap to change your mind.

Work through the seven sections below before you reach out. You don't need a finished answer for every line, just enough clarity that you can explain it out loud. Anything still fuzzy is exactly what a scoping call is for.

SECTION A

Project Vision & Goals

Get this right and every later decision gets easier. Get it wrong and even a well-built product can miss the point.

- ☐ The core problem this project solves is written down in one or two sentences.
- ☐ The primary business goal is defined (cut manual work, launch a new revenue stream, replace an aging system, etc).
- ☐ Who will use it is identified: internal staff, external customers, or both.
- ☐ What “success” looks like six months after launch is defined as a number, not just a feeling.

SECTION B

Scope & Features

Scope is the single biggest driver of both cost and timeline. This is the section worth spending the most time on.

- ☐ Must-have features for a first usable version (MVP) are listed separately from “nice to have later.”
- ☐ The three to five most important user actions are mapped out end to end (e.g. “customer signs up, books a slot, pays”).
- ☐ Any existing systems this needs to talk to are named: CRM, ERP, accounting software, payment gateway, and so on.
- ☐ Whether this replaces an existing system or is brand new is clear, and if it's a replacement, what data needs to move over.

SECTION C

Platforms & Technical Requirements

These answers shape the architecture, so even rough ranges are far more useful than no answer at all.

- ☐ Platform(s) needed are decided: web, iOS, Android, desktop, or a combination.
- ☐ Expected number of users at launch and roughly one year out, even as a rough range, is known.
- ☐ Any compliance or data-handling requirements are known (GDPR, HIPAA, PCI-DSS, data residency rules, etc).
- ☐ Hosting preference is known, or you're open to a recommendation (cloud provider, on-premise, no preference).

SECTION D

Design, Brand & Content

Design work moves faster when it starts from something real instead of a blank page.

- ☐ Logo, brand colors, and fonts are ready to share, or you've flagged that they still need to be created.
- ☐ Two or three apps or sites whose look or flow you like are bookmarked, even from competitors.
- ☐ Existing content, copy, or data that needs to be migrated or loaded in is identified.
- ☐ Any accessibility requirements are known (e.g. WCAG compliance for public-sector or enterprise clients).

SECTION E

Budget, Timeline & Decision-Making

This is the section that turns a wish list into a plan that actually ships.

- ☐ A realistic budget range is set, even if it's a range rather than a fixed number.
- ☐ A target launch date exists, and whether it's a hard deadline or a flexible goal is clear.
- ☐ Everyone who needs to approve scope, design, or budget changes is identified up front.
- ☐ How often you want progress updates (weekly demo, async written reports, etc) is decided.

SECTION F

After Launch

A product doesn't stop needing decisions the day it ships. Deciding these now avoids a scramble later.

- ☐ Who handles bug fixes, updates, and hosting after launch is decided: the dev team, an internal team, or a hybrid.
- ☐ Whether end users will need training or documentation is known.
- ☐ What you want to track once it's live is defined: usage analytics, conversion events, error monitoring.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT OVER

Three mistakes that cost the most time

Treating the first version like the final version.

Most scope and budget overruns trace back to trying to launch everything at once instead of a focused MVP. A smaller v1 that ships sooner almost always beats a complete v1 that ships late.

Skipping the “who approves what” conversation.

Projects stall when feedback arrives from five people with five different opinions, at five different points in the build. Naming one decision-maker per area before work starts removes most of that friction.

Leaving hosting and maintenance undecided until launch week.

Someone has to own the server bill, the renewal dates, and the 2am alert. Deciding who that is before launch is far cheaper than figuring it out during an outage.

FOR REFERENCE

Typical cost & timeline ranges

Planning-stage ranges, not quotes. Where your project lands depends on the answers above; a clearer checklist generally lands at the lower end of its range. Want an instant estimate based on your own answers? Use the free calculator at qllmsoft.com/software-development-cost-calculator.

Project type	Typical cost	Typical timeline
Website / Web App	\$1,500 – \$6,000	4 – 8 weeks
Mobile App	\$3,000 – \$12,000	8 – 14 weeks
Enterprise / Custom Software	\$8,000 – \$25,000	12 – 20 weeks
AI & Automation	\$4,000 – \$15,000	8 – 16 weeks

Ready to scope your project?

Fill this out as far as you can get, gaps included, and send it our way. We'll reply within 24 hours with next steps or a fixed-price proposal.

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